

THE AUTHORITY LIFECYCLE

HOW CONFERRED AUTHORITY CAN DIVERGE FROM CURRENT LEGITIMACY OVER TIME.

Authority may be appropriate when it is conferred. Organizational conditions change continuously. The authority a system holds may cease to reflect what current circumstances justify. Runtime Governance evaluates that difference when authority is exercised.

THE REALITY



Authority may be appropriate when conferred.



Organizational conditions change continuously.



The authority a system holds may cease to reflect what current circumstances justify.



Runtime Governance evaluates that difference when authority is exercised.

WHAT DRIVES CHANGE



Role / job changes



Manager changes



Policy updates



Group / entitlement changes



Contractor / vendor expiry



Device posture changes



Risk / threat changes



Agent context changes

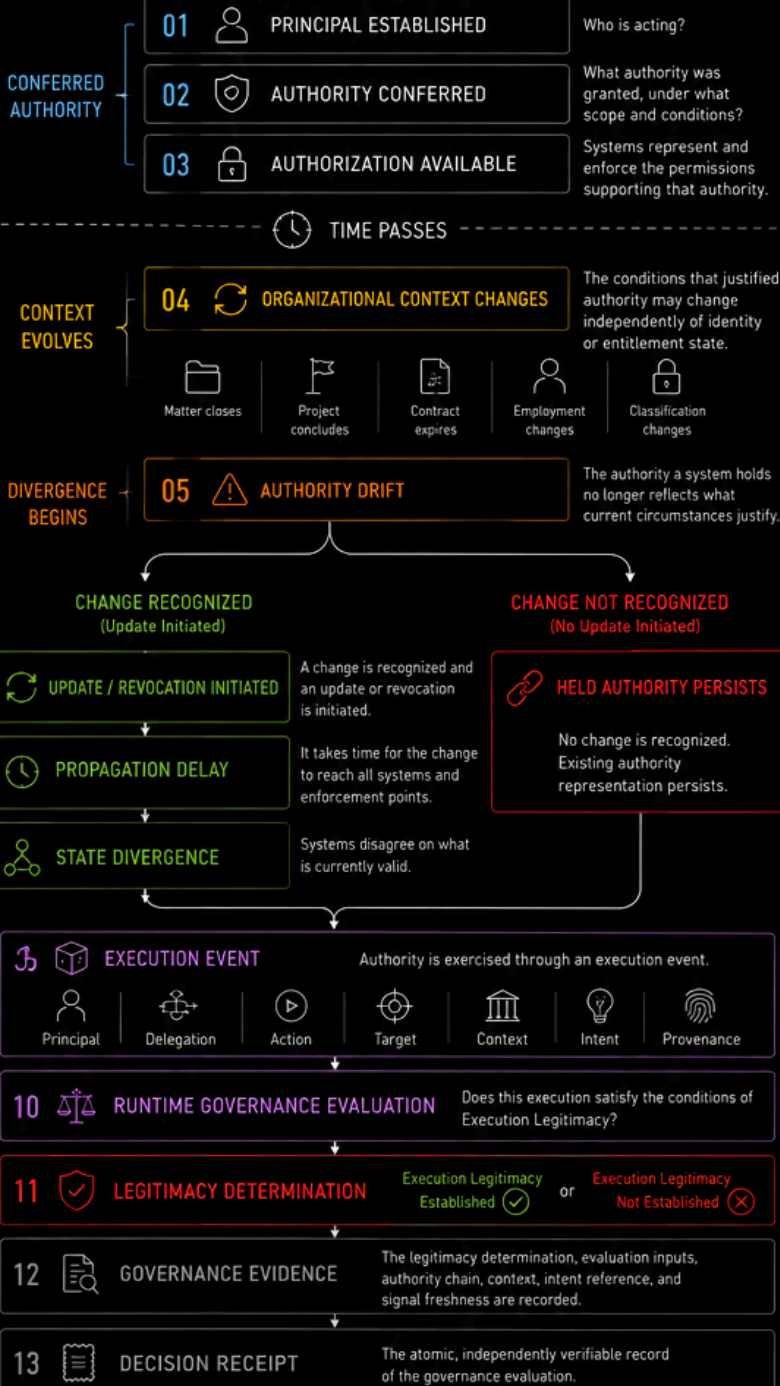


System latency & sync delays

LEGEND

- Conferred Authority
- Context Evolves
- Divergence Begins
- Change Recognized Path
- Change Not Recognized Path
- Evaluation & Determination
- Evidence

THE AUTHORITY LIFECYCLE



HOW AUTHORITY DRIFT CAN PERSIST



BUSINESS-STATE CHANGE

Organizational context changes without an identity-plane event or signal.



REVOCATION DELAY

A recognized authority change has not reached all enforcement points.



STATE DIVERGENCE

Systems disagree about current authority, entitlements, or context.



STALE AUTHORIZATION STATE

Execution relies on state that no longer represents current conditions.



INCOMPLETE DELEGATION CONTEXT

The authority chain or its boundaries cannot be fully reconstructed.



EVIDENCE INSUFFICIENCY

The legitimacy determination cannot be independently verified.

OUTCOMES OF RUNTIME GOVERNANCE

- Execution legitimacy can be evaluated.
- Authority drift can be surfaced when authority is exercised.
- Governance determinations can be connected to current context.
- Evidence can support independent verification.
- Higher-consequence actions may be gated where architecture requires it.

EXISTING CONTROLS REMAIN FOUNDATIONAL



Identity state



Device posture



Risk signals



Policy



Requested operation

Does current policy permit this request?



RUNTIME GOVERNANCE



Execution Event



Authority



Delegation



Context



Intent



Provenance

Is this execution a legitimate exercise of conferred authority?

DIFFERENT EVALUATION OBJECTS. COMPLEMENTARY DISCIPLINES.



GOVERNANCE LAW

AUTHORITY MAY REMAIN VALID.
THE CONDITIONS THAT JUSTIFIED IT MAY NOT.

Authority Drift is the divergence between authority a system holds and the authority its current circumstances would justify.

Runtime Governance evaluates the difference when authority is exercised.

